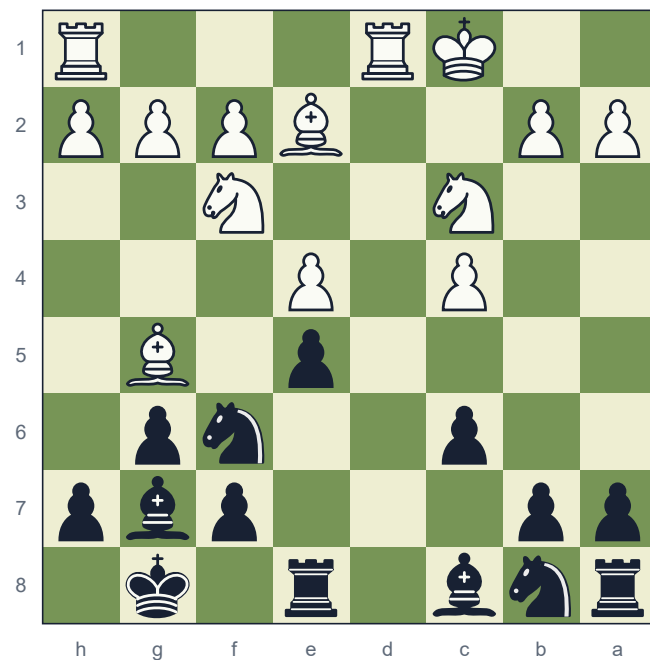


Exchange Variation - play the queenless middlegame

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. dxe5 dxe5 8. Qxd8 Rxd8

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Recapture with the d-pawn. If White exchanges queens, activate the rook and contest d4. Do not measure success by whether you get a kingside attack.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

The d-file opens, with White's e4 pawn facing Black's pawn on e5. Open files and minor-piece squares matter more than opposite-wing races.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White may exchange queens, develop Bg5, or enter a quiet maneuvering game. White retains the first-move initiative but has given up the d5 wedge.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Activate a rook on the open file.
2. Protect e5 before chasing a bishop.
3. Trade only when the resulting minor-piece position improves.

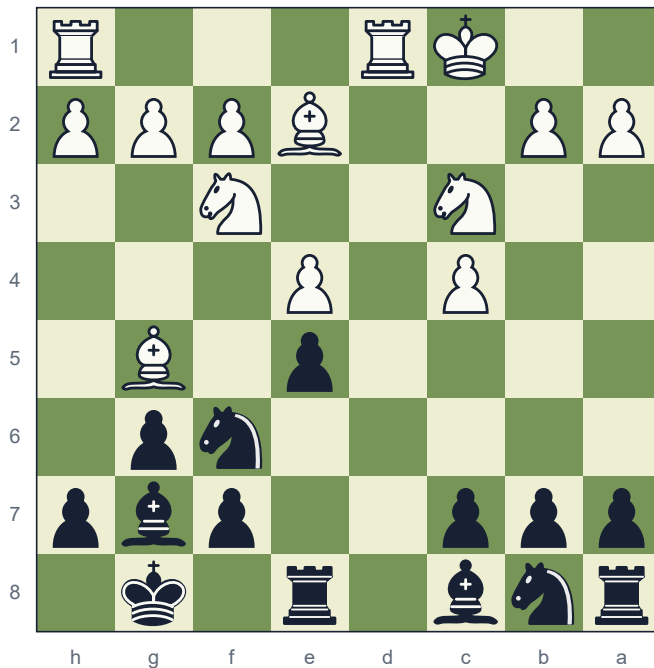
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Queens off and Bg5

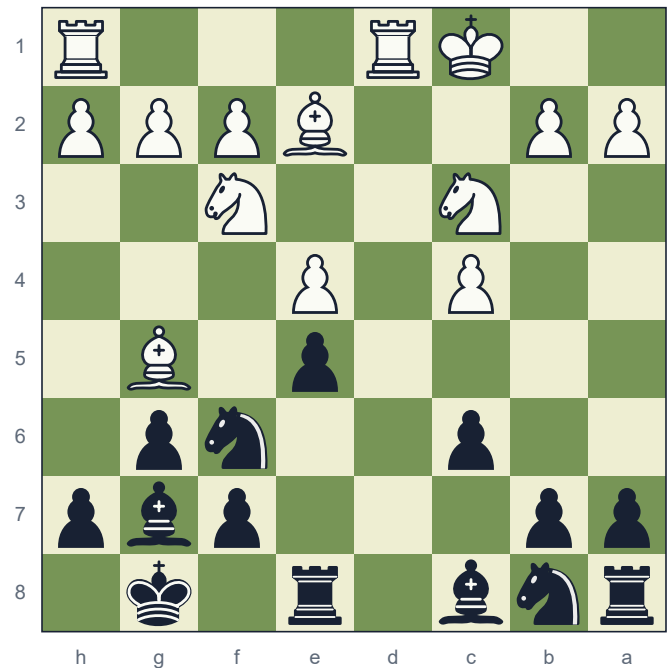
STUDY LINE 06-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. dxe5 dxe5 8. Qxd8 Rxd8 9. Bg5 Re8 10. O-O-O c6

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 10... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The rook recaptures on d8. Bg5 and long castling increase White's pressure, so ...Re8 supports e5 and ...c6 controls d5.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop the b8 knight and the c8 bishop, then challenge the d-file. Watch for a knight reaching d5.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The lack of queens does not remove tactics. Pins and rook invasions still win material.

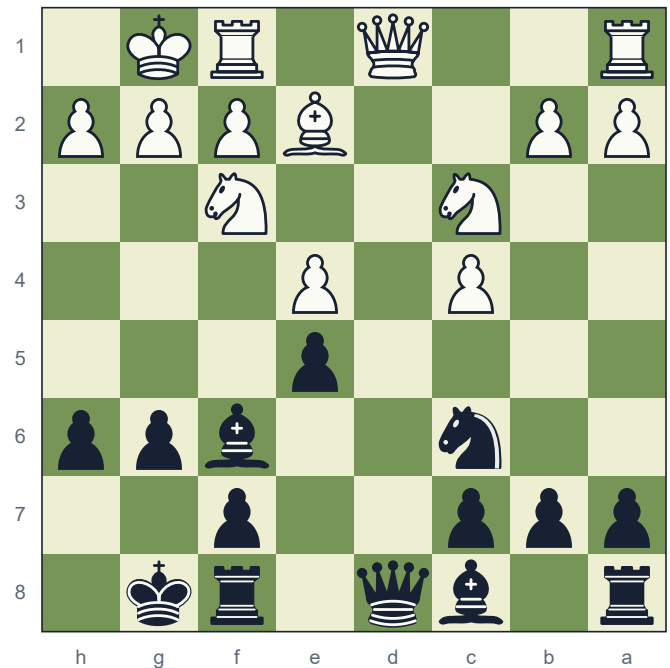
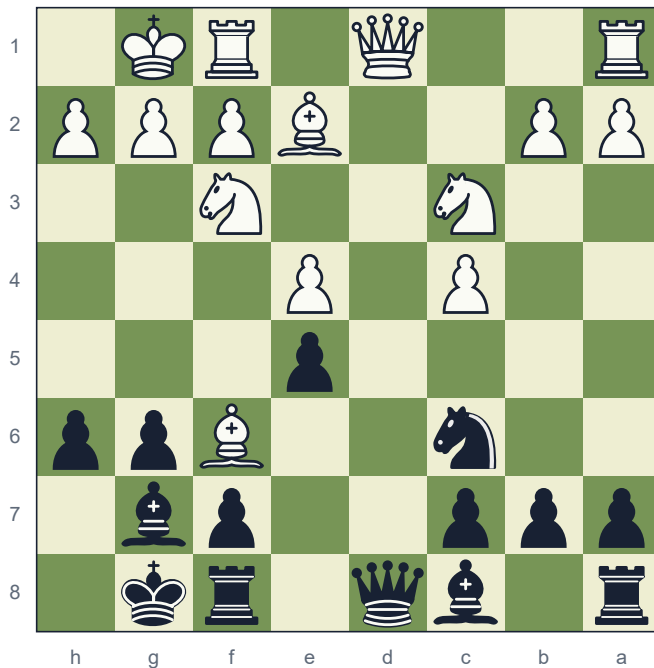
REMEMBER King safety improves, but calculation remains necessary.

02 White develops without trading queens

STUDY LINE 06-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. dxe5 dxe5 8. O-O Nc6 9. Bg5 h6 10. Bxf6 Bxf6

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



WHY THESE MOVES

White gives up the bishop to change your minor-piece balance. Recapturing with the bishop retains healthy pawns and a bishop pair.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Complete development and contest d4. Preserve the bishops when they have useful open diagonals.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not assume a bishop pair is automatically better; compare the knights' entry squares.

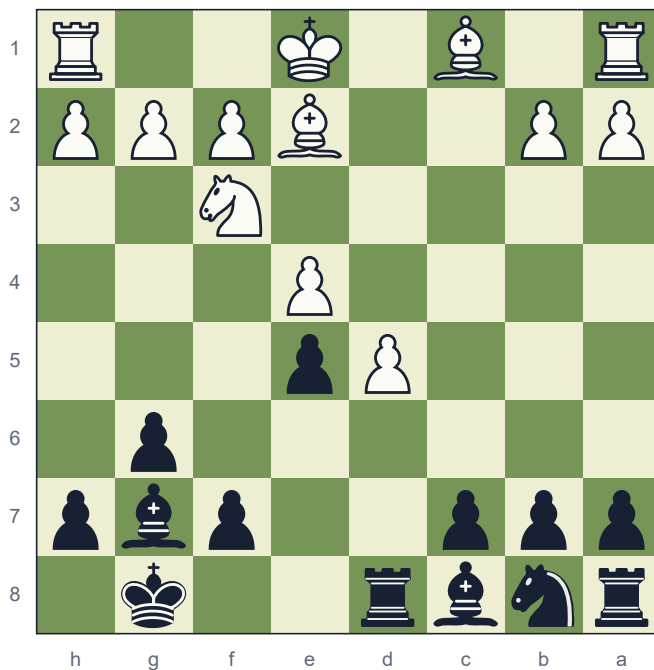
REMEMBER Keep the structure and activate the pair.

03 Nd5 after the queen trade

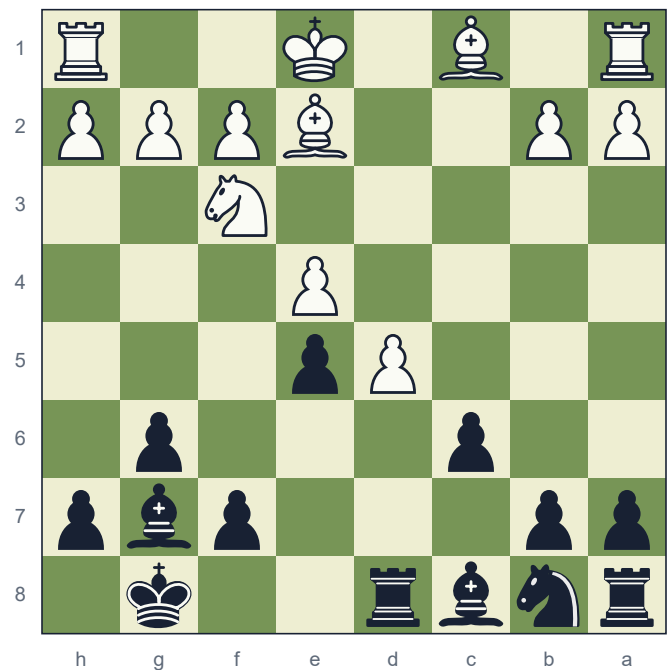
STUDY LINE 06-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. dxe5 dxe5 8. Qxd8 Rxd8 9. Nd5 Nxd5
10. cxd5 c6

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 10... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White exchanges a knight to create a pawn on d5. ...c6 challenges that new wedge before it becomes a permanent cramp.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

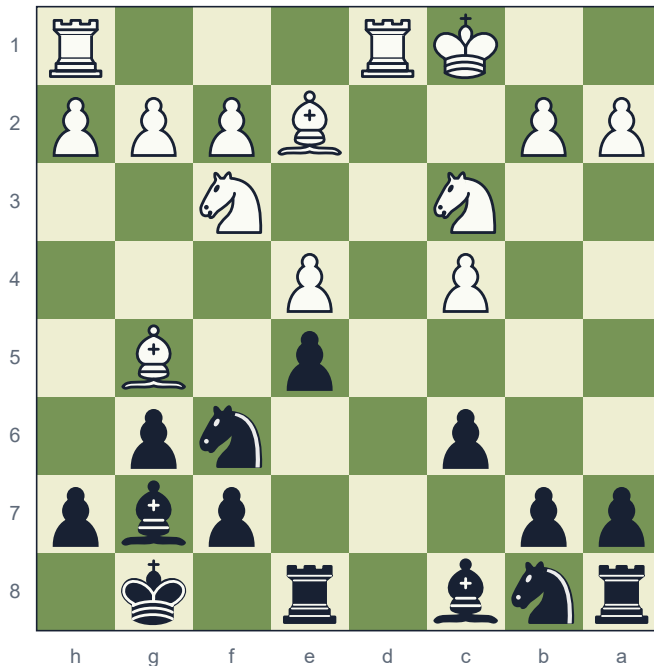
Evaluate dxc6 and ...cxd5 concretely. Use the open files and the g7 bishop as the structure changes.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Recaptures can create a passed pawn or expose a rook. Follow the entire exchange sequence.

REMEMBER Challenge a new wedge at its base.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

The d-file opens, with White's e4 pawn facing Black's pawn on e5. Open files and minor-piece squares matter more than opposite-wing races.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may exchange queens, develop Bg5, or enter a quiet maneuvering game. White retains the first-move initiative but has given up the d5 wedge.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Develop the b8 knight and the c8 bishop, then challenge the d-file. Watch for a knight reaching d5.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.